



△ de Havilland DHC1
Chipmunk 1946

Origin Canada/UK

Engine 145 hp de Havilland Gipsy Major 8 air-cooled inverted 4-cylinder

Top speed 139 mph (223 km/h)

Designed in Canada as a replacement for the RAF's Tiger Moth trainers, the tandem-seat "Chippie" was a great success and became popular in the 1950s civilian conversions; 1,277 were built.



△ Fairey Firefly 1944

Origin UK

Engine 1,730 hp Rolls-Royce Griffon IIb, later 2,330 hp Griffon 72

Top speed 386 mph (621 km/h)

This carrier-borne naval fighter, reconnaissance, and strike aircraft entered service in 1944, also carrying out anti-submarine and bombing raids. Fireflies served in the Korean War and on into the 1960s.



△ Hawker Sea Fury 1945

Origin UK

Engine 2,480 hp Bristol Centaurus XVIIC supercharged air-cooled 18-cylinder radial

Top speed 460 mph (740 km/h)

Conceived as a light fighter, this aircraft was quickly adapted to carrier use with folding wings. It proved extremely effective, even holding its own against jet fighters in Korea; 864 were built.



△ Westland Wyvern 1946

Origin UK

Engine 2,690 hp Rolls-Royce Eagle 22 liquid-cooled 24-cylinder flat-H

Top speed 383 mph (616 km/h)

When it became apparent that controlling thrust with propeller pitch would facilitate deck landings, this piston-engined prototype became a turboprop torpedo fighter.



△ Convair B-36J
Peacemaker 1946

Origin US

Engine 6 x 3,800 hp Pratt & Whitney R-4360 "Wasp Major" radial 28-cylinder +4 x General Electric J47-19 jets

Top speed 418 mph (673 km/h)

The largest, mass-produced piston-engined aircraft ever with the longest combat aircraft wingspan, the B-36 could carry nuclear bombs at 47,000 ft (14,325 m) on transcontinental flights. It served from 1949 to 1959.

▷ Grumman HU-16A Albatross 1949

Origin US

Engine 2 x 1,425 hp Wright R-1820-76 Cyclone 9 air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 236 mph (380 km/h)

Military air-sea search and rescue craft, the sturdy Albatross was stable enough to land in heavy seas and able to take off in 8-10 ft (2.5-3 m) seas with jet or rocket assistance. It operated worldwide.

